

and run into local restrictions. When providing bank account information to an exchange, it's especially important to have done the research on that entity to ensure security. Providing bank account information to any financial entity online is not to be taken lightly.

### Is the Service Geographically Constrained?

Some exchanges are restricted by geography, and thus will require an address for access to certain aspects of their services. This is particularly relevant for New York residents, where the BitLicense has made it considerably harder for cryptoasset startups to operate. The BitLicense was a piece of regulation put in place in 2015 that required companies interfacing with cryptoassets to go through a lengthy and expensive regulatory process to operate in New York, which led the majority of cryptoasset startups to cease operations in the state.

### What Are the KYC and AML Requirements?

Know your customer (KYC) and anti-money laundering (AML) regulations are increasingly mandatory for cryptoasset exchanges in the United States and are designed to protect against illegal and/or fraudulent activity. In opening an account, consider the amount of personal information required. Exchanges such as Bitstamp, GDAX, and Gemini have been proactive in working with regulators to require more detailed information on customers signing up for an account. Such information can delay the opening of an account, often by a